Tridosha Theory: Decoding Your Ayurvedic Blueprint

Comprehensive Study Guide & Exam Prep

Objective: Master the biological application of the 5 Elements (Pancha Mahabhuta) and the 3 Doshas (Vata, Pitta, Kapha) for objective examination.

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The Five Great Elements (Pancha Mahabhuta)

EARTH

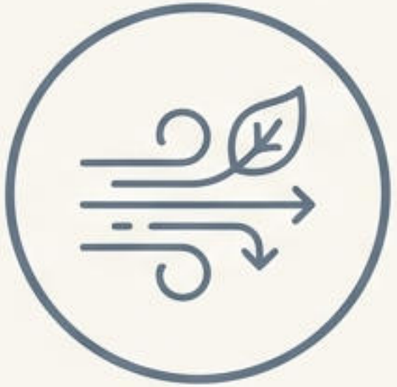
Solid structures: Bones, Flesh, Skin.

WATER

Fluids: Saliva, Urine, Blood, Sweat.

FIRE

Transformation: Heat, Digestion, Metabolism.



AIR

Movement: Breath (Inhale/Exhale), Life force.

SPACE (ETHER)

Empty areas: Arteries, Intestines, Nasal passages.

EXAM QUESTION

Q: Which element represents the heat that transforms food?

A: Fire

Q: Empty spaces in arteries correspond to which element?

A: Space/Ether

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The Tridosha Equation

Air

+

Space

= **VATA**

The Energy of Movement
(Movers & Shakers)

Fire

+

Water

= **PITTA**

The Energy of Transformation
(Digestion & Metabolism)

Earth

+

Water

= **KAPHA**

The Energy of Structure & Lubrication
(Stability)

EXAM QUESTION

Q: A biological combination of Earth and Water results in which Dosha?

A: Kapha

Q: Which Dosha is responsible for metabolism?

A: Pitta

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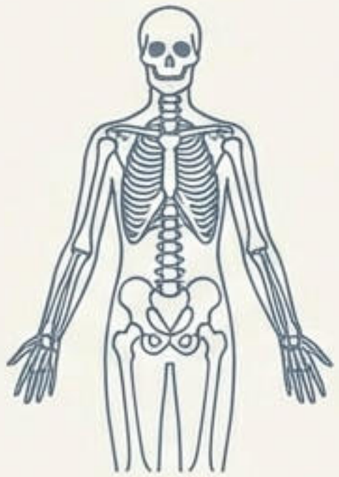
Phase 2: Observation | Anatomy & Weight

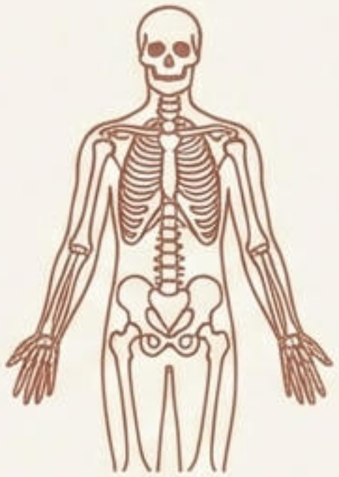
VATA



Structure: Narrow frame (shoulders/hips).

Weight: Thin; difficult to gain weight.

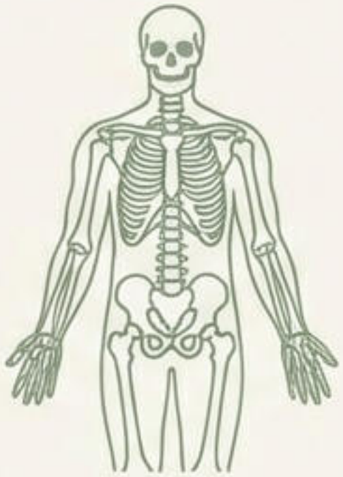
PITTA



Structure: Medium frame.

Weight: Moderate; gains and loses easily.

KAPHA



Structure: Wide frame (broad shoulders/hips).

Weight: Heavy; easy to gain, struggles to lose.

SCENARIO QUESTION

Q: A patient with a wide frame who complains that they "drink water and gain weight" likely has a dominance of...?

A: Kapha

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Observation: Skin, Temperature & Hair

	VATA	PITTA	KAPHA
SKIN	Dry, rough. Absorbs moisturizer rapidly.	Oily, prone to acne/redness.	Thick, smooth, oily. Needs no moisturizer.
TEMPERATURE	Cold intolerant. Loves sun.	Heat intolerant. Dislikes summer.	Generally comfortable.
HAIR	Dry, frizzy, scanty.	Straight, thin. Premature graying.	Thick, lustrous, shiny.

EXAM QUESTION

Q: Premature graying and straight, thin hair are characteristic of?

A: Pitta

Q: Which body type cannot tolerate cold?

A: Vata

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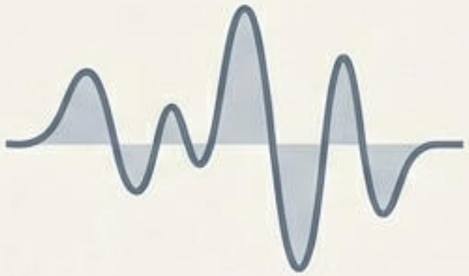
Physiology: Metabolism & Digestion

VATA	PITTA	KAPHA
		
Sweat: Scanty.	**Sweat:** Profuse, strong smell.	**Sweat:** Moderate.
Hunger: Irregular (Variable).	**Hunger:** Sharp (Hangry if meal skipped).	**Hunger:** Low/Calm (Can fast easily).
Digestion: Gas, bloating, constipation.	**Digestion:** Fast/Quick.	**Digestion:** Slow/Sluggish.

EXAM QUESTION

Q: Irregular hunger and bloating indicate?

A: Vata

Q: Profuse sweating and body odor indicate?

A: Pitta

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Observation: Sleep, Eyes & Speech

VATA	PITTA	KAPHA
Eyes Small, dry.	**Eyes** Medium, intense/sharp gaze.	**Eyes** Large, thick lashes.
Sleep Light sleeper, insomnia prone.	**Sleep** Moderate, wakes ready to go.	**Sleep** Deep, heavy sleeper.
Speech Fast, erratic flow.	**Speech** Clear, assertive, decisive.	**Speech** Slow, thoughtful.

SCENARIO QUESTION

Q: Who wakes up frequently during the night?
A: Vata

Q: Assertive, to-the-point speech characterizes?
A: Pitta

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Mental Style: Work & Learning Archetypes

VATA

The Hummingbird

- **Work:** Multitasks, starts many projects, juggles ideas.
- **Learning:** Fast learner, fast forgetter.
- **Negative Emotion:** Anxiety, Fear.

PITTA

The Laser

- **Work:** Goal-oriented, perfectionist, competitive.
- **Learning:** Fast learner, useful recall.
- **Negative Emotion:** Anger, Frustration.

KAPHA

The Rock

- **Work:** Consistent, deep focus, dislikes change.
- **Learning:** Slow learner, “Elephant Memory” (never forgets).
- **Negative Emotion:** Depression, Lethargy.

EXAM QUESTION

Q: Who learns slowly but retains information for years?

A: Kapha

Q: Anxiety is the primary imbalance of?

A: Vata

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VATA PROFILE: The Mover

Composition: Air + Ether

- **Key Qualities:** Cool, Dry, Light, Quick.
- **Superpowers (Balanced):** Creativity, adaptability, enthusiasm, spiritual awareness.
- **Imbalance Symptoms (Aggravation):**
  - **Physical**: Weight loss, dry skin, constipation, restlessness.
  - **Mental**: Racing mind, anxiety, fear, insomnia.
  - **Behavior**: Overspending money.

EXAM QUESTION

Q: Feeling ungrounded or restless is a sign of excess...?

A: Vata

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Prescription: Balancing Vata

The Anti-Wind Protocol

Golden Rule: Opposites Balance. Vata needs Warmth, Oil, and Stability.

DIET (Do's & Don'ts)

- **EAT:** Cooked grains, root veggies (pumpkins, sweet potato), healthy fats/nuts.
- **AVOID:** Raw salads, dry snacks (crackers/popcorn), cold foods.

LIFESTYLE

- **Snehan:** Internal and external oiling (Self-massage).
- **Movement:** Slow strength training & Yoga. Avoid intense cardio.
- **Routine:** Strict daily routine to create stability.

EXAM QUESTION

Q: Why avoid raw salads for Vata?

A: They are dry/cold, aggravating Vata qualities.

Q: Best exercise for Vata?

A: Slow Yoga/Strength.

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PITTA PROFILE: The Transformer

Composition: Fire + Water

- **Key Qualities:** Hot, Sharp, Oily, Intense.
- **Superpowers (Balanced):** Leadership, Leadership, intelligence, discipline, organization.
- **Imbalance Symptoms (Aggravation):**
  - **Physical:** Acidity, heartburn, skin rashes/acne, high blood pressure.
  - **Mental:** Anger, criticism (self & others), controlling behavior.

EXAM QUESTION

Q: Acidity and high blood pressure suggest an imbalance in?

A: Pitta

Q: Which Dosha is prone to perfectionism?

A: Pitta

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Prescription: Balancing Pitta

The Cooling Protocol

Golden Rule: Opposites Balance. Pitta needs Cooling and Hydration.

DIET (Do's & Don'ts)	LIFESTYLE
• **EAT:** Water-rich foods (melons, cucumber, coconut water). Sweet fruits. • **HERBS:** Mint, fennel, rose petals. • **AVOID:** Pungent/Spicy foods (chilies), pickles, salty/oily foods.	• **Environment:** Stay cool, avoid peak sun. • **Mindset:** Non-competitive activities. Practice patience.

EXAM QUESTION

Q: Which taste aggravates Pitta?

A: Pungent (Spicy).

Q: Best drink for Pitta imbalance?

A: Coconut water.

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KAPHA PROFILE: The Preserver

Composition: Earth + Water

- **Key Qualities:** Heavy, Stable, Cold, Slow, Oily.
- **Superpowers (Balanced):** Calmness, stamina, loyalty, steady energy, memory.
- **Imbalance Symptoms (Aggravation):**
  - **Physical:** Rapid weight gain, congestion/mucus, sleeping too much.
  - **Mental:** Lethargy, depression, feeling ‘stuck’, attachment.

EXAM QUESTION

Q: Excess mucus and congestion signal which imbalance?

A: Kapha

Q: Which Dosha struggles most to lose weight?

A: Kapha

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Prescription: Balancing Kapha

The Stimulation Protocol

Golden Rule: Opposites Balance. Kapha needs Lightness, Dryness, and Stimulation.

DIET (Do's & Don'ts)	LIFESTYLE
• **EAT:** Spices! (Ginger, pepper, turmeric). Light fruits (berries/apples). Water-rich veggies. • **AVOID:** Dairy, sweets, nuts, rich grains, pastries.	• **Movement:** Intense cardio is mandatory (Running, HIIT). • **Routine:** Wake up early. Avoid daytime naps.

MCQ SPOTLIGHT

EXAM QUESTION

Q: Which Dosha benefits from spicy food?
A: Kapha (cuts the heaviness).

Q: Why avoid dairy for Kapha?
A: Increases mucus/heaviness.

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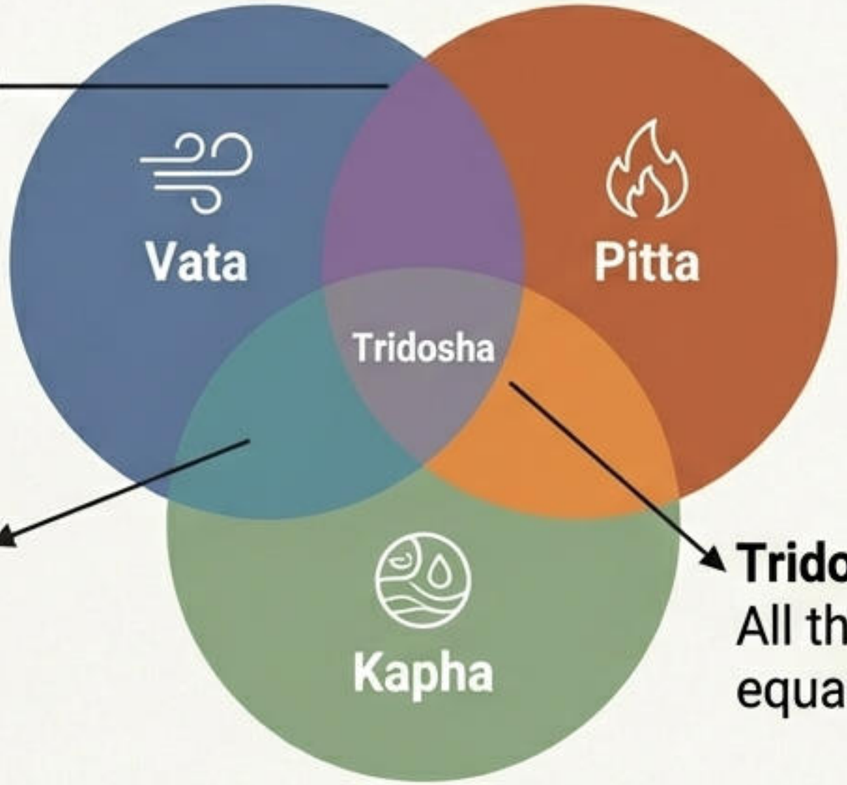
The Reality of ‘Prakriti’ (Nature)

Single Dosha: Rare (e.g., pure Vata > 70%).



Dual Dosha: Most Common. Two doshas dominate (e.g., Vata-Pitta).

Tridosha: Rare. All three in equal balance.

MCQ SPOTLIGHT

EXAM QUESTION

Q: What is the term for birth constitution?

A: Prakriti

Q: Most common body type?

A: Dual Dosha

Don’t compare. A rose cannot be a jasmine; an elephant cannot be a giraffe. Health is balancing YOUR unique blueprint.

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The ‘Night Before’ Cheat Sheet

	VATA	PITTA	KAPHA
Elements	Air + Ether	Fire + Water	Earth + Water
Keywords	Dry, Moving, Cold	Hot, Sharp, Intense	Heavy, Stable, Slow
Imbalance	Anxiety, Gas, Pain	Acidity, Anger, Rashes	Mucus, Weight, Depression
The Cure	Warmth + Routine	Cooling + Calming	Stimulation + Cardio
Best Food	Root Veg, Grains, Fats	Melons, Cucumber	Spices, Light Fruit

“When Vata is balanced, you are creative. When Pitta is balanced, you are focused. When Kapha is balanced, you are calm.”

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